ANSHA MONTESSORI TEACHER TRAINING INSTITUTE (AMTTI)

- A Division of Ansha Group of Education

PRE-SCHOOL MANAGEMENT

MONTESSORI TEACHER TRAINING COURSE

Course Code: AMTTC–001

Prepared in accordance with the requirements of
Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE)
and Teacher Training Programmes

Head Office:

Ansha Montessori Teacher Training Institute (AMTTI)
Dhanalaxmi Street, South Laxmi Nagar,
Opposite Nayara Petrol Bunk,
Mudichur, Chennai – 600 048, Tamil Nadu, India

Email: mudichur@anshamontessori.com
Phone: +91 98417 26893 | +91 70103 02155

ABOUT THE INSTITUTION

Ansha Montessori Teacher Training Institute (AMTTI) is a division of the Ansha Group of Education, established in October 2014 with the objective of promoting quality teacher education in early childhood care and education.

The institute is committed to preparing competent and professionally trained educators through a structured Montessori-based approach. AMTTI emphasizes child-centred education, developmentally appropriate practices, and the creation of a prepared learning environment that supports holistic child development.

The institute adopts a balanced training methodology that integrates theoretical foundations with supervised practical experience, enabling trainee teachers to acquire essential pedagogical skills, classroom management techniques, and professional competence required for early childhood education settings.

AMTTI functions with the support of an experienced academic and administrative team and adheres to recognized educational standards to ensure the quality and relevance of its teacher training programmes.

ABOUT THE FOUNDER

Mrs. Shakila Hussain, Founder of Ansha Montessori Teacher Training Institute, holds academic qualifications including M.Phil, M.Ed, and PGDGC. With more than 15 years of experience in the field of education, she has played a key role in establishing and guiding the institute with a focus on academic integrity, professional teacher preparation, and child-centred educational practices.

INSTITUTIONAL PHILOSOPHY

The institute is grounded in Montessori principles such as observation, freedom with responsibility, and respect for the child. AMTTI views the learning environment as a supportive and structured space that encourages independence, responsibility, and active participation in the learning process.

PREFACE

Good management helps maintain a unity of directions and actions that are being carried out in any organization effectively and efficiently. It also ensures the planning and arrangement of all the resources involved. An ECCE centre also requires good administration and management to achieve its goal of providing the required learning environment that will promote and ensure the holistic development of children.

NEP 2020 stresses the vitality of the ECCE. This material deals with the basic concept of Management and Administration and how to deal with Human, Physical, Financial and Community resources of an ECCE centre.

The material is a result of collective efforts of subject experts, teachers and teacher-educators. The compilers and the advisory team hope with this material a support to the ECCE teachers by giving a hand to care their children. We are thankful to all those who gave their support and assistance in compiling this material. We welcome comments and constructive suggestions to bring further improvement in the quality and usability of this material.

Regards

Development Team

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Unit 1: LEARNING ENVIRONMENT

1.1 INTRODUCTION

A learning environment is more than just a classroom—it is a space in which students feel safe and supported in their pursuit of knowledge, as well as inspired by their surroundings. Think back to some of the classroom environments you have encountered on your educational path. In your childhood, the learning environment you engaged in was probably vibrant and colourful.

As students continue to grow and evolve as learners, so do the environments in which they learn. Learning environments have changed over time and can continue to expand to meet the student needs, allowing teachers to continually optimize their learning environment to help students meet their educational goals.

Learning environment is a broad term that can refer to a culture, a context, an approach to teaching and learning, or a physical location in which education and work take place.

1.2 CLASSIFICATION

1.2.1 Physical

Those vibrant, colourful classrooms of your youth or the rows of desks that characterized high school both fall into the category of the physical learning environment. This category is all about the design of a classroom, including how it is laid out to influence learning, and which spaces are deignated for learning activities. This can include the furniture used to fill the space and even the equipment a teacher relies on to enhance the learning experience.

1.2.2 Psychological

A positive psychological environment can encourage students to engage with the curriculum—and their fellow students—in ways that can enhance their personal and professional development. By building trust with students and creating a safe space that feels welcoming for all, teachers create a positive learning environment and make sure students have more opportunities to participate, ask questions, take risks, and receive feedback.

1.2.3 Emotional

School can be stressful at any age, which is why students need a positive emotional environment that supports their educational path. Part of creating the psychological environment's safe space means addressing the emotional environment's need for self-expression and the freedom to express emotions. By supporting students' emotional needs and feelings, teachers help enhance their students' emotional intelligence—which, in turn, gives them confidence. Teachers can also create a supportive emotional learning environment by creating routines students can rely on, encouraging diversity and choices, and celebrating their achievements.

1.3 DESIGNING CHILD-FRIENDLY LEARNING ENVIRONMENT

Safety and learning of the children becomes the most challenging task. Designing physical space for young children blended with pedagogy and safety may help in their process of learning. Physical space for young children's activities may vary from centre-to-centre and setting-to-setting (urban, rural, semi-urban and tribal) depending upon the availability of space and number of children.

1.3.1 Designing Indoor Environment with Activity Areas

Activity areas are established places in the classroom with resources that actively engage children and they may change according to the themes or topics.

Importance of Activity Area

- It helps children exercise their choices and explore what interests them.
- It provides opportunities to create, draw, manipulate, discover, learn new skills, make mistakes, modify their strategies and gives a sense of achievement after they have mastered the activity in which they were engaged, such as building a tower, fixing the jigsaw puzzle or solving a maze.
- It helps in their socio-emotional development, as children learn to play with other children, share, take turns in using the material, wait till the other child finishes her/his activity.
- It helps in fine and gross motor development as children play with water, sand, manipulate things.

Setting up Activity Areas

Activity areas should invite and promote active, independent exploration and discovery, creating an atmosphere in which children can learn. It should contain a variety of manipulative materials that children can use in creative ways. The materials should be displayed and kept attractively on the open shelves for easy accessibility to encourage exploration. The material should be stored in such a way that children can start playing without adult help and be able to arrange the material and clean up after they have finished playing. Each classroom may have several activity areas, such as art area, block building area, doll and dramatic play area, maths, manipulative science, discovery area, music and movement area, sand and water play area, book reading area, etc.

Classroom Displays

Classroom displays are very important in preschool classrooms. Displays may be used to convey a theme being covered in the classroom. This makes children curious and interested in the theme. Samples of children's work can also be displayed on the display board. The following must be kept in mind while displaying children's works:

- Displays should be at the eye level of children so that they can see them easily.
- Samples of both in-process and finished work of children should be displayed so that the process of learning is also valued as the final product.
- Displays should be changed regularly.
- Work of each child should be displayed, not only the best ones (may be on rotational basis).
- Displays should be purposeful.
- Displays should be relevant and current.

Seating Arrangement

It is important that the seating arrangement in preschool be flexible and adaptable to different arrangements to suit different activities in preschool classrooms like large group activity, small group activities, music and movement, art activities, individual or small group instruction by the teachers, reading aloud to children, which require different types of seating arrangements.

Classroom Adaptations

If there are children with special needs then classroom adaptations with regard to physical facilities and teaching-learning processes becomes essential.

Suggested below are some adaptations and modifications which can be considered in preschools for children with disabilities:

- Simplify and repeat instructions and directions.
- Provide opportunities for practicing skills repeatedly.
- Provide immediate feedback in a positive and descriptive manner.
- Plan a schedule which is developmentally appropriate (duration and order of activities, time for transitions, etc.).
- Provide choices to children so that they can follow their interests and strengths.
- Provide concrete examples and materials, such as textured letters, numbers, etc.
- Provide support for transitions (visual and verbal cues, songs, materials, ringing bell).
- Discuss children's feelings and provide individual attention.
- Allow children to demonstrate/communicate their understanding in multiple ways.

1.3.2 Designing Outdoor Play Environment

Outdoor play environments should provide a blend of natural areas, environmental features and plants to interest children in learning about nature and its elements. Important features include unstructured spaces and activities for creative learning and spontaneous play.

The need for setting the outdoor play, maximising the space, and ensuring safety of children is important while designing outdoor play environment. The outdoor area must be free from animals, poisonous plants, dangerous insects or any kind of harm to young children.

Following are the benefits of playing outdoors:

- Better physical health
- Numerous opportunities to strengthen motor skills
- Stress relief
- Greater visual-motor integration (or the ability to control hand or body movement guided by vision)
- Greater creativity
- Stronger verbal and social skills
- Production of vitamin D (an essential vitamin for bone health) through exposure to sunlight
- Increased attention and cognitive abilities

1.4 ROLE OF TEACHERS

The teacher has to arrange the classroom in appealing activity areas as per the available space, interests of children and the themes being covered. It must be ensured that the material in activity areas provide opportunities for exploration, investigation, individual and group play. The selected material should have loose parts and be open-ended so that it empowers creativity in children to think, plan and carry out their play in a variety of ways. Teachers can also design and make a variety of low cost and no cost play and learning material.

The teacher should routinely check the contents of activity areas for safety and replace unattractive materials by more appealing materials which children enjoy to play with. The teacher needs to provide support for ongoing activities by enriching interventions without being intrusive in children's play. During play in activity areas, teacher may be able to identify children with developmental needs or emotional problems and she can provide required support and intervention.

Based on the available play material and the size of activity area, teacher should Decide the maximum number of children who may work in an activity area to avoid crowding at one or two centres.

1.5 SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- Define Learning Environment.
- List out the benefits of playing outdoors.

1.6 PRACTICAL WORK / PROJECT / ASSIGNMENT

- Conduct a Panel Discussion on conducive learning environment of ECCE Centres.

For further reading

- https://eclkc.ohs.acf.hhs.gov/learning-environments
- https://www.youngacademics.com.au/what-makes-a-successful-learning-environment-in-childcare/

Unit 2: ADMINISTRATION AND MANAGEMENT OF EARLY CHILDHOOD CARE AND EDUCATION (ECCE) CENTRE

"Administrators make work for each other so that they can multiply the number of their subordinates and enhance their prestige."

– **C. Northcote Parkinson**

2.1 INTRODUCTION

The word Administration was originated from Latin word 'AD' (TO) and 'MINISTAIRE' (SERVE) – To SERVE or to act or to manage. In general terms, administration can be described as a decision-making body in any organization or Centre. Administration is defined as the act of managing duties, responsibilities, or rules. An example of administration is the act of the principal in the school managing the faculty and staff and employing the rules of the school system. An administrator is a person who is in a position of authority or who manages people, practices and policies. An example of an administrator is a principal.

2.2 DEFINITIONS OF ADMINISTRATION

John A. Veig says, "Administration is determined action taken in pursuit of conscious purpose".

E. N. Gladden says, "Administration is a long and slightly pompous word, but it has a humble meaning, for it means, to care for or look after people, to manage affairs".

Luther Gulick says, "Administration has to do with getting things done; with the accomplishment of defined objectives."

George E. Berkeley says, “Administration is a process in which values and common goals work together.”

2.3 ADMINISTRATION OF ECCE CENTRE

After understanding all the definitions, let us say in simple line, Administration is a process of controlled action according to goals, aims and objectives of policies of Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) Centre.

For instance, a school where each and every year has a year plan, month’s plan, even week or day plan for different activities like curricular activities or co-curricular activities, to happen there in the school and behind each and every activity, some set of desired learning aims are expected.

Therefore, a well administration is needed for ECCE Centre to be successful. Administration is the process of smooth running of an ECCE Centre. It also helps in the controlling act of managing activities of an ECCE Centre.

2.4 AIMS AND IMPORTANCE OF ADMINISTRATION IN ECCE CENTRE

- Without an effective administration, an ECCE Centre would not run professionally and smoothly.
- Ensures the smooth flow of information from one part to the other within the ECCE Centre for effective and efficient performance.
- It also includes the performance or management of ECCE Centre’s operations and decision-making.
- An efficient administrative people can help to achieve targeted goals within assumed time frame.

- To direct activities towards common goals and objectives, a good administration policy should be followed in the ECCE Centre.
- Create some rules and regulations for smooth functioning according to need.
- Make decisions time to time when required, in the interest of the all stakeholders.
- Managing various operations to ensure certain desired action should be happening in time like parents meeting, community meeting, curricular activities, etc.
- Choosing required staff (teaching or non-teaching) for best performance of particular assignment or upcoming events.
- Clear cut direction for activities of various units to achieve set goals and ensuring effective and efficient performance.
- Connecting links between senior management and all teaching and non-teaching staff so that information flow should be properly there in ECCE Centre.

2.5 MANAGEMENT

Mary Parker Follett defined management as “the art of getting things done through people”. Management is a process of planning, decision making, organizing, leading, motivation and controlling the human resources, financial, physical, and information resources of an organization to reach its goals efficiently and effectively.

Management in organizations is the function that coordinates the efforts of people to accomplish goals and objectives by using available resources efficiently and effectively.

2.5.1 Role and Importance of Management

Essentially, the role of management is to guide the organization towards goals. Every organization exists for certain purposes or goals, and managers are responsible for combining and using organizational resources to ensure that their organizations achieve their purposes.

The role of management is to move an organization towards its purposes or goals by assigning activities that the organization members perform. If management ensures that all the activities are designed effectively, the output of each individual worker will contribute to the attainment of the organizational goals.

- **It helps in Achieving Group Goals -** It arranges the factors of production, assembles and organizes the resources, integrates the resources in an effective manner to achieve goals. It directs group efforts towards achievement of pre-determined goals.

- **Optimum Utilization of Resources -** Management utilizes all the physical and human resources productively. This leads to efficacy in management.

- **Reduces Costs -** It gets maximum results through minimum input by proper planning and by using minimum input and getting maximum output. Management uses physical, human and financial resources in such a manner which results in best combination. This helps in cost reduction.

- **Establishes Equilibrium -** It enables the organization to survive in changing environment. It keeps in touch with the changing environment.

- **Essentials for Prosperity of Society -** Efficient management leads to better economical production which in turn helps to increase the welfare of people.

Good Management makes a difficult task easier by avoiding wastage of scarce resource

2.5.2 Steps in Management

Management process is a systematic way of doing things. We refer to management as a process to emphasize that all managers, irrespective of their aptitude or skill, engage in some inter-related functions in order to achieve their desired goals.

Luther Gulick has given a keyword "POSDCORB" to explain the functions of management, where: P stands for Planning, O for Organizing, S for Staffing, D for Directing, Co for Co-ordinating, R for Reporting, and B for Budgeting.

Planning and Decision Making: Determining Courses of Action

Planning is the process of thinking about and organizing the activities required to achieve a desired goal. It involves the creation and maintenance of a plan. Planning means setting an organization's goal and deciding in advance how best to achieve them. Planning is decision making regarding the goals and setting the future course of action from a set of alternatives to reach them.

Organizing: Coordinating Activities and Resources

Organizing is the function of management that involves developing an organizational structure and allocating human resources to ensure the accomplishment of objectives. The structure of the organization is the framework within which effort is coordinated. Organizing can be defined as the process by which the established plans are moved closer to realization. Once a manager sets goals and develops plans, his next managerial function is organizing human and other resources that are identified as necessary by the plan to reach the goal.

Staffing

This section relates to the personnel policy and all related activities within an organization. Good and competent personnel are crucial for an organization to function effectively. It is the task of the manager to first identify the extent of skills and experience required for certain positions. Based on this, job profiles are drawn up and personnel can be recruited. In this sense, selection and training procedure falls under this staff policy and ensures that the right type of employees is in the right place.

Directing

Direction, of course, lies in the hands of the manager; he/she is the person with final responsibility and is accountable for this function. Direction means instructing, guiding and motivating people to achieve organizational goals. The manager not only motivates his/her employees but also guides them to take up certain challenges at work, encourages them and gives them direction.

Coordinating

With this concept, it is the task of the manager to connect different sections and to achieve cooperation. A good manager has a so-called helicopter view, which gives him/her an overview of what is happening and what still needs to be done. From this perspective, he/she is able to coordinate tasks and manage employees. It is his/her task to synchronise different departments and to bring them together with the right end goal in mind.

Reporting

Without reporting, there is no evidence. A clear report keeps communication open throughout the entire organization. Managers are the linking pin between the management team and their own employees, and are accountable for consistency. Reporting provides insight into the progress and agreements and can also be recorded in this way.

Budgeting

Finance is the lifeblood of any organization. The manager is responsible for the management, expenditure and control of the organization's budget and also handling expenses and tax details. If wasteful spending, overruns, errors or evasion are discovered, the manager is responsible for taking action.

2.5.3 Role of Communication in Management

Communication is simply the act of transferring information from one place, person or group to another. Every communication involves (at least) one sender, a message and a recipient. The English word 'communication' has been derived from the Latin word 'communicare' which means to impart or participate or transmit. The word 'communicate' is derived from the root 'communis' which means to make common or to share.

We can say that effective communication is a building block of successful organizations. In other words, communication acts as organizational blood.

Importance of Communication in an Organization

The importance of communication in an organization can be summarized as follows:

1. Communication promotes motivation by informing and clarifying to employees about the task to be done, the manner in which they are to

Perform the task, and how to improve their performance if it is not up to the mark.

2. Communication helps to monitor and control performance and helps to improve performance if it is not up to the mark.
3. Communication is a source of information to the organizational members for decision-making process as it helps identify and assess alternative courses of action.
4. Communication also plays a crucial role in altering individuals' attitudes. Informed individuals will have better attitude than a less-informed individual. Organizational magazines, journals, meetings and various other forms of oral and written communication help in moulding attitudes.
5. Communication also helps in socializing. In today's life only the presence of another individual fosters communication. It is also said that one cannot survive without communication.

2.6 SUPERVISION

The English word supervision comes from the Medieval Latin word *supervidere*. This is the combination of two words: *super* (over) and *videre* (to see). Supervision is the act of watching a person or activity and making certain that everything is done correctly, safely, etc. It is the act or process of directing a person or group of people according to pre-determined set objectives. Therefore, supervision is the act or process of overseeing something or somebody. A person who performs supervision is called supervisor. A person who is getting supervision is the supervisee.

2.6.1 DEFINITION OF SUPERVISION

According to M. S. Viteles, “Supervision refers to the direct, immediate guidance and control of subordinates in the performance of their jobs.”

According to R. C. Davis, “Supervision is the function of assuring that the work is being done in accordance with the plans and instructions.”

Thus, supervision is concerned with the direction, guidance, control and maintenance of the subordinates. A supervisor performs these tasks in any institution or centre.

2.6.2 SUPERVISION OF ECCE CENTRE

- Supervision is essentially the practice of monitoring the performance of ECCE Centre staff, noting the merits and demerits and using suitable techniques to improve the shortcomings.
- It is an interactive process between two or more persons with a combination or integration of processes, activities and actions.
- It has also been described as a continuous guiding process aimed at development of children in ECCE Centre.
- A means of helping teachers to ensure and achieve excellence in teaching-learning and results in oriented smooth functioning of the ECCE Centre.

2.6.3 AIMS AND IMPORTANCE OF SUPERVISION IN ECCE CENTRE

- Checking on the availability of teaching-learning materials.
- Advising on the appropriateness of the teaching-learning materials in use.
- Advising on the ECCE Centre environment.
- Promoting curriculum change and innovation.
- Providing feedback on teacher performance.

- Identifying needs for staff development.
- Conducting quality assurance checks.
- Ensuring teacher motivation and morale.
- Providing professional support and guidance to the teacher.

2.6.4 FEATURES OF SUPERVISION IN ECCE CENTRE

- Supervision provides opportunity for learning in case there are any gaps in the knowledge or skills of the service provider.
- Supervision helps in understanding ground realities and challenges, and a good supervisor can suggest or provide means to overcome the problems.
- Supervision motivates the ECCE teacher to perform well.
- Supervision helps in building the team.
- Supervision also helps in making the teacher aware of new guidelines and notices.
- Supervision helps the teacher relate better to the community.

2.7 DIFFERENCES BETWEEN ADMINISTRATION AND SUPERVISION IN ECCE CENTRE

1. Administration executes, directs to the pre-planned function of ECCE Centre and supervision advises, stimulates, explains, leads and guides at the time of functioning of ECCE Centre.
2. Administration decides and orders executions according to already agreed policies by stakeholders, while supervision helps to decide and order execution and assists in improving instruction for best performance therein ECCE Centre at the time of events execution.

2.8 SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- Define Management.
- Differentiate Management with Administration.
- Discuss the importance of administration in management of an ECCE Centre.

2.10 PRACTICAL WORK / PROJECT / ASSIGNMENT

- Prepare an interview schedule for teachers to know the functions of an ECCE Centre.

2.11 FURTHER READING

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Unit 3: FINANCIAL RESOURCES

"Finance without strategy is just numbers, and strategy without finance is just dreaming."

— (E. Faber)

3.1 INTRODUCTION

Without sufficient or enough amount of fund we cannot walk a single step in the development of an ECCE centre. In fact, that day itself we must need to check adequate amount of fund is required for running ECCE Centre smoothly and purposefully. This is why we must have a deep understanding of concepts of finance and various sources of financing for ECCE Centre. What is budget in ECCE Centre? What are sources for financing ECCE Centre? Why do we need to keep financial record? Etc. Therefore, let us have a journey of learning in depth about various dimension of financing of ECCE Centre in this chapter.

3.2 MEANING OF FINANCE

Finance derives from the Latin word *finis* and old French word *fin* for 'end', which originally means 'end'. The French word for finance came to mean both payment and ending, but in the 18th century, the English adapted it to the management of money. Finance is the process of raising funds or capital for any kind of expenditure. Finance is defined as "to provide money or credit for something". For instance, finance is a bank lending someone money to purchase a house, getting education, buying a car etc. It is the process of channelizing various funds in the form of credit, loans or invested capital to those profit or non-profit organizations that most need them or can put them to the most productive use such as any business entity, non-profit organization and schools, etc.

3.3 DEFINITION OF FINANCE

L. J. Gitman says, “Finance can be defined as the art and science of managing money.”

E. F. Brigham says, “Finance is the study of how people and institutions raise, allocate, and use money.”

S. H. Hall says, “Finance is a body of facts, principles and theories dealing with raising and using of money by individuals, businesses and governments.”

After analysing the above discussion and definitions of authors, we can define finance as the application of financial planning for individuals, businessmen, firms and organizations to collect money from short-term, mid-term and long-term convenient sources to ensure financial investment and control according to that financial plan.

3.4 CONCEPT OF FINANCE IN ECCE CENTRE

Actually, finance can be defined as the art and science of managing money properly while operating or proper functioning of ECCE Centre. Like other organization, ECCE Centre also needs huge fund for operational as well as fixed expenditure such as fund for building & furniture, different teaching tools, various learning aids, staff salary etc. Therefore, finance for ECCE is the process of raising funds or capital for any kind of expenditure to run the Centre.

3.5 FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT IN ECCE CENTRE

The financial management is generally concerned with procurement, allocation and control of financial resources of an ECCE Centre. The objectives can be:

- To ensure regular and adequate supply of funds in ECCE Centre.
- To ensure adequate returns so that ECCE Centre can develop its various resources.
- To ensure optimum funds utilization. Once the funds are procured, they should be utilized in maximum possible way, at least cost for making cost effective utilization of ECCE Centre funds.
- To ensure safety of funding and for appropriate utilization.
- To plan a sound allocation of funding structure in the ECCE Centre etc.

3.6 IMPORTANCE AND PURPOSE OF FINANCE IN ECCE CENTRE

- The importance of finance in ECCE Centre is the ability to ensure that a centre operates without any financial hiccups.
- Like running short of cash, and at the same time making sure that funds are secure and well invested for the achieving of determined goals of centre.
- To support smooth execution of ECCE Centre, planning and decision-making.
- For allocating resources, reviewing opportunities for updated performance and sometimes debt financing, and other functions within ECCE Centre.
- Finance exists in an ECCE Centre to make decisions more easily, to judge what is happening, and to decide on the best option.

3.7 SOURCES OF FINANCE IN ECCE CENTRE

All ECCE Centres require funds to run successfully. With growing demands and rising expenses, we need to explore various sources to meet these growing demands. We can get support from the government and these stakeholders in the children's well-being and success in life. One can approach the concerned ministries (e.g., Ministry of Women and Child Development) and departments (e.g., Education) for financial support. One can also avail scholarships or schemes of financial support from the government, if eligible. The financial support requested could be partial or full. Some ways to raise fund for the ECCE Centre are:

1. Public Funds

Public funds mean any money received from public entity from appropriate taxes, fees, interest or other returns on investment. For instance, monthly or yearly fees collection from parents and others.

2. Private Funds

A private equity fund is a collective investment scheme used for making investments in various equity (and to a lesser extent debt) with private equity. Private equity investment strategies are typically limited partnerships with a fixed term of 10 years (often with annual extensions).

3. Public–Private

Public-private source of financing involves collaboration between a government agency and a private-sector institution that can be used to finance ECCE Centre.

4. Partnerships

A financial partnership is a partnership in which one or more of the partners finance or ECCE Centre as much required while the other partner focuses on its operations.

5. International

International finance is the study of monetary interactions that transpire between two or more countries. International finance focuses on foreign direct investment and currency exchange rates for the operation of ECCE Centre. Such as aids from UNESCO or from others forum. Increased globalization has magnified the importance of international finance.

6. Agencies

Financial agencies refer to the bodies which may provide funds by collecting loans, giving grants based on private social responsibility (CSR) etc.

7. Donations

The ECCE staff can ask parents for donations. The parents could donate as per their capacity. If an ECCE Centre is located in an urban area, a fixed fee can be charged from all parents for providing services to their children. Some extra donations may be collected from families and other donors.

8. Organize Materials and Stationery Donation Camp

Many people may not be able to donate in cash but they can help by donating in kind. They can donate old toys, clothes, vehicles, used containers or any other object which can be used by children of the ECCE Centre. The staff can organize camps for collecting crayons, blocks etc. The staff can also request donations for three or four days. The Centre may inform the donors accordingly.

9. Fund Raising

ECCE workers can organize fair or cultural functions at the Centre. The Centre could display and sell articles made by children or parents/community members. The visitors are asked to buy these articles, priced to include some profit to help raise funds.

10. Volunteering

"A penny saved is a penny earned." One can save money not only through monetary donations but if skilled parents or community people can also help by providing voluntary services for ECCE Centre. They can also help in the classes or they can contribute in preparing learning materials for children. For example, all parents can make toys like dolls, visual charts, blocks with small boxes etc. They can also prepare small articles for sale in fairs or exhibitions organized by the Centre and save money.

11. Renting Out the Space

As ECCE Centre's maximum working hours are till 1:00 p.m. So, after this the indoor space can also be rented for other purposes like running dance class or art and craft classes etc. Further, outdoor space can be used for growing fruits and vegetables, which can be sold to generate funds.

12. Grant-in-aid from the Government

Besides the annual grant given by the Government for ECCE Centre, mini-grants can be requested by the ECCE owner for additions like to build or update playground equipment or to develop learning materials. These mini-grants are useful, but may not be able to meet the total financial help needed. The available schemes of financial support can be accessed on the sites of the various ministries and departments associated with child welfare and development.

3.8 BUDGETING

After fund mobilization, the next important step is budgeting. A budget is a plan for future income and expenses that you can use as a guideline for spending. Budgets are an essential feature of the control system and as such, an integral feature of effective management.

- Gather information. Collect information regarding sources of income or expense. The key for this process is to create a monthly average, so the more information you can dig up the better.
- Record all of your sources of income. Record the total income as a monthly amount.
- Create a list of monthly expenses. Write down a list of all the expected expenses you plan on incurring over the course of a month.
- Break expenses into categories: fixed and variable. Fixed expenses tend to stay the same (or close to the same) from month to month. They include bills such as your rent or mortgage, cable, internet, utilities, fixed loan repayments and so on. These expenses for the most part are essential and not likely to change in the budget.
- Variable expenses change from month to month. They include things like gas, groceries, your daily coffee, eating out and entertainment to name a few. Variable expenses also include occasional expenses. These expenses come up from time to time. This category will be important when you need to make adjustments to your spending habits.
- Total your monthly income and monthly expenses. If your end result shows more income than expenses, you are off to a good start. If you are showing more expenses than income, adjustments need to be made.

Budget Review and Adjustment

- Make adjustments to expenses. If you have correctly identified and listed all of your expenses then what you should be aiming to do is to have your income and expense columns to be equal. All of your income is accounted for and budgeted for all of your expenses.
- If you are in a situation where your expenses are higher than the money you are bringing in, you will have to look at variable expenses to find areas where you can cut your spending. Since these expenses are typically discretionary in nature, it should be easier to trim a few dollars here or there until you are closer to matching your income.
- Review your budget monthly. It is important to review your budget on a regular basis to make sure you are staying on track. After the first time and compare the actual expenses versus what you created in your budget. Then take time to adjust your budget.
- Track your spending over the next few months to develop a base in journaling and keep receipts for everything. Create a spreadsheet. After tracking your spending for a few months, go back to your budget and adjust it if you need to. This will show you where you did well and where you may need to improve.
- Budgets are for saving too. If you have some money left over in your budget after you have paid the bills, add to your savings. Build an emergency fund for unexpected bills that come up (like a lost bus pass or car repair). The more you save, the sooner you'll reach your financial goals.
- Balance your budget. If you are new to budgeting, your budget may not balance the first time you try. You might have to look for places where you can spend less and make adjustments along the way.

MANAGEMENT AND UTILIZATION OF FUNDS

- Financial management at ECCE Centre deals with procurement and allocation of funds, along with monitoring their use that is whether funds are utilized for the purposes for which they were meant.
- A financial plan is essential for effective and efficient utilization of funds.
- It helps you in evaluating your present financial status and setting goals for running of the Centre.
- It also provides evidence of funding sources, indicating that you have researched and planned the future financial management of your Centre.
- Preparing a budget is the first step of financial planning for the Centre. The budget helps in forecasting the expenditures and estimating the revenues like where the money will come from for the future.
- After doing this, you will get an idea of the financing gap or the difference between income and expenditure that you face. Accordingly, you can adjust your income and expenditure figures.
- Either you can set priorities to cut your expenditures or can identify more sources of funds.
- Budgeting also provides scope for financial adjustments in case of change of priorities or emergencies. Based on your budget, you can establish a plan of action over a specific period of time.
- All financial transactions need to be recorded promptly and accurately. Monthly review of expenses and income should be conducted.
- If possible, external auditing of the centre's financial records should be done annually
- All staff should take the lead in demanding and enforcing proper financial management of the Centre's fund

3.9 MAINTENANCE OF FINANCIAL RECORDS AND REGISTERS

Financial records are essential for carrying out Centre activities. Like other resources, finances require strict regulation and management. Financial records need to be maintained for auditing and reporting purposes, knowing about the financial position of the Centre, and to know how their contributions are being used. By keeping financial records, the Centre is able to make this information available whenever needed. Financial records at ECCE Centre include cash book, ledger and balance sheet. Let us read about these in detail.

3.9.1 Factors to be considered while preparing record

Following points should be kept in view while preparing records:

1. Record must be accurate.
2. It must be concise.
3. It must be clear and complete.
4. It must be relevant.
5. It must be written neatly.
6. It must be kept up-to-date.
7. Number of the pages consecutively either in the red ink or with a number machine when a register is opened.
8. Avoid overwriting.
9. Make all the entries in ink.
10. Get each cutting attested by the Head.
11. Do not open new volume of a register every year. If the previous volume contains some blank pages, continue using it.

12. Make all the entries in a prescribed register and do not leave any blank space between entries.

3.9.2 Suggested books and records to be kept in an enterprise

1. Journal – Sub-division of journals may be prepared like Purchases Day Book, Sales Day Book, Purchases Returns Day Book, Sales Returns Day Book, etc.
2. Ledger
3. Cash Book
4. Bank Deposit Books
5. Cheque Books
6. Petty Cash Books
7. Contingent Register
8. Acquittance Roll
9. Fee Collection Register
10. Bill Register
11. Register of Donations
12. Pay Bill Register

3.9.3 Basic Accounts Needed for Pre-schools

Cash book / Day Book:

A financial journal that contains all cash receipts and payments, including bank deposits and withdrawals. Entries in the cash book are then posted into the general ledger. The cash book is periodically reconciled with the bank statements as an internal audit. A cash book is a record of small value purchases before they are later transferred to the ledger and final accounts.

Ledger

A ledger is the principal book or computer file for recording and totaling economic transactions taken place at ECCE Centre. It has separate columns for debits and credits, and a beginning monetary balance and ending monetary balance for each account.

Balance Sheet

A balance sheet lists all of the assets that an ECCE Centre owned as well as the debts owed by it. Assets are listed separately, first and then liabilities are listed together. The assets are grouped into two different categories: current assets and long-term assets. The current assets represent all the assets that an ECCE Centre expects to be used or converted to cash within the next year.

Long-term assets are those assets that you don't plan on converting to cash within the next year such as land, building and equipment. Long-term liabilities refer to those obligations that won't be paid off within a year such as loan. This is very helpful to know the financial status of an ECCE Centre. It is important that all ECCE providers know how to use analysis and read this document.

3.10 ENTREPRENEUR SUPPORT SCHEME

It is a support scheme started by the Government of Kerala to support the new enterprises in the field of production. Under this scheme, up to Rs. 30 lakhs will be given to the enterprise in three steps:

1. Start-up support
2. Investment support
3. Technology support

3.11 TAX FILING

Every profit gaining enterprise should file the income tax return annually. But start-ups will not be required to pay income tax on their profits for the first three years and will also be exempted from capital gains tax.

3.12 FINANCIAL CHALLENGES

These are common financial challenges that ECCE Centre face often:

- Monthly spending exceeds income.
- ECCE Centre doesn't have a provision as an emergency fund.
- More rent keeps going up.
- Lack of income / fee collection.
- Unexpected expenses.
- Too much debt by ECCE Centre.
- Need for financial independence.
- Overspending or lack of budgeting.
- Bad credit.
- Lack of savings etc.

3.13 SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- What are the funding sources available for ECCE Centre? Explain.
- What are the challenges to arrange funds for ECCE Centre in rural and urban India? Compare.
- List some methods to raise finances for setting up an ECCE Centre.

3.14 PRACTICAL WORK / PROJECT / ASSIGNMENT

- Prepare a Project Report on effectiveness of budgeting in ECCE Centre.
- Collect some records and registers required for an ECCE Centre.

3.14 FURTHER READING

- Gupta, S. (2009). *Early Childhood Care and Education*. New Delhi: PHI Learning Pvt. Ltd.
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- Shukla, R. P. (2004). *Early Childhood Care and Education*. Sarup & Sons.
- Sidhu, K. W. (1996). *School Organisation and Administration*. New Delhi: Sterling Publishers.
- https://www.iscorg/media/files_public/03/03/d8c6-69a-4710-998c-e97f8a15f1f4/financing-budgeting-guidebook.pdf
- https://cbps.in/our-blog/ecec/

Unit 4: PHYSICAL RESOURCES

4.1 INTRODUCTION

An ECCE centre should be a place for joyful learning for children between the ages of three to eight years. Young children strive to make sense of the world in which they live. They need an environment that is rich in sensory stimulations and which provides opportunities for using their imagination and creativity. This lesson is divided into two sections. The first section focuses on identification of location, dealing with space management. The second section is on infrastructural facilities.

4.2 IDENTIFICATION OF LOCATION

Since surroundings have such a powerful influence on pre-schoolers, there are few things you need to keep in mind when locating an ECCE centre. The location of the centre should have the following:

- Easy accessibility
- Cleanliness and hygiene and pollution-free environment
- Safety and security
- Barrier-free environment for differently-abled children

4.3 INFRASTRUCTURE / PHYSICAL FACILITIES

Physical facilities in an ECCE centre include both outdoor as well as indoor facilities. In this section, besides outdoor and indoor facilities, we shall also discuss the importance of water and toilet facilities in an ECCE centre.

4.3.1 Outdoor Facilities

Outdoor play is an integral part of the natural activity of children. The elements that make the outdoor space an engaging learning environment are:

Besides sufficient space, opportunities to explore, use of imagination and creativity, it allows children to take risks within a safe and secure environment. Therefore, utilizing the available outdoor space to its maximum and maintaining it properly for safety and security of children becomes very important. The outdoor facilities include playground, sandpit, grass covered area, etc.

a) Playgrounds

All playgrounds should incorporate three kinds of areas, which can generally be categorized as open, quiet and active.

- **Open area** to run and play comprising of playground, lawn, concrete paths (for cycling) and shed. But if we do not have enough space in the centre premises, the teacher can take children to nearby park or open ground whenever possible.
- There should be **quiet areas** like areas of low vegetation, trees, landscaping, vegetable garden, sand area, etc.
- **Active area** includes swings, rope, gyms, slides, rope ladders etc. for development of gross motor skills in children. Low cost/waste items (like tyres) can also be used to make swings.
- Provision for a small grass covered area to play could promote the health of children.

b) Sandpit

The sandpit is generally considered an important part of outside activity. Its size should be adequate for the number of children who will be using it at any one given time. The sand should be filled to a suitable depth, clean, washed and non-staining.

4.3.2 Indoor Facilities

The indoor space, properly arranged, plays a key role in supporting and developing children's learning and development. It should provide children with stimulation and challenge, and encourage their creativity and imagination. At the same time, it should also encourage independence and help children to develop a positive attitude towards learning.

Indoor facilities in an ECCE centre include well-lit, ventilated rooms, storage space, safe floor covering, etc.

Important aspects of indoor facilities:

- **Size:** The indoor space should be large enough to accommodate a desirable number of children. If the indoor space is too little to accommodate all children, they can be divided into groups and a few groups can be engaged in outdoor activities while the rest may be involved in indoor activities.
- **Ventilation:** Good ventilation helps to keep the indoor environment comfortable and can contribute positively to children's learning. It can be provided through low-height windows, electric fans, exhaust fans etc.
- **Lighting:** The quality and quantity of light influences the moods and feelings of children and their teacher. It can be enhanced through the use of light shades and proper placement of windows and ventilators. In the presence of adequate natural light, tube lights should be used. However, preference should be given to natural light.
- **Storage space:** An ECCE centre should have enough storage space for toys, blocks, books, bags, teaching aids, equipment, music instruments etc. So, the indoor space should have deep almirahs and low shelves so that children can use them whenever they want.
- **Floor covering:** The floor should be covered with mattresses if possible, to ensure children's safety. The use of natural material is advised for comfort.

- **Surfaces:** Surfaces should be of material that can easily be cleaned and maintained.
- **Walls and roofs:** The walls may be either of bricks, mud, stone or cement but they should be safe, strong and durable. The roof can be made of cement, bamboo or banana leaves or any other locally available materials but it should be strong and safe.
- **Water facility:** The problem of safe drinking water still exists in many centres which give rise to many water borne infectious diseases among children. Availability of safe drinking water is a basic requirement in an ECCE centre/school.
- **Toilet facility:** Many parents do not send their child to school because the school does not have separate toilet for girls. The centre should have separate toilets for boys and girls. Children's toilets must be of suitable size and height for the age group catered for. Wash basins and soaps/handwash must be at a level which is easily accessible to children.

4.4 EQUIPMENT AND LEARNING MATERIALS

Children continuously grow and learn. With their imagination, they transform a match box into a car, a twig into a tree or a piece of stone into an animal. They do not need expensive toys and equipment to learn. All they need is developmentally-appropriate play and learning materials with appropriate guidance. It provides them opportunity to understand themselves and the world in which they live.

4.4.1 Types of Equipment and Learning Materials

The equipment at the centre is broadly classified as indoor equipment and outdoor equipment.

(a) Indoor Equipment and Learning Materials:

It consists of blocks, toy utensils and other materials for pretend play. It also includes puzzles, manipulative toys/games, materials for art activities etc.

(b) Outdoor Equipment and Learning Materials:

It includes climbers, slides, swings, jungle-gym, see-saw, balance beam, rope ladder, sports equipment (child-size basketball hoop, balls (variety of sizes and textures), plastic bats, hockey sticks), wheel toys (wagons, push pull toys, wheelbarrows, scooters), riding toys (variety of sizes with and without pedals, for use by one or two children), tumbling mats, ropes, wooden twigs, sand boxes, sandpit measuring cups/spoons, variety of containers, plastic bottles, things that sink or float, natural items such as shells, pieces of wood, rocks etc.

4.4.2 Selection of Equipment and Learning Materials

It is through play that children learn. Hence, play material is also their learning material. Due consideration is necessary in choosing the right equipment and learning material for the centre. Often, funds allocated for play material are limited. So one needs to plan well on how to use the allocated money.

Age-appropriateness:

All the learning materials and equipment should be relevant for the age group of the children for whom they are selected for promoting physical, language, cognitive and socio-emotional development.

Multiple Uses:

Children can use sand, water or play dough in a variety of ways, depending on their ability, past experience with the material and interest. So, while choosing play and learning materials, it should be ensured that the material has multiple uses. For example, a wooden block can be used as seats in outdoor space for merry-go-round or even as slide by joining wooden stumps and planks. It gives children a sense of creativity and control over their play and learning.

Adequacy:

Since the curriculum includes indoor/outdoor, individual/group activities, so the learning materials and equipment should be adequate in terms of quantity and proportion to ensure access to all children for all types of activities planned in the curriculum.

Variety:

It is essential that there should be a large range and variety of equipment and materials in the centre to suit the needs, abilities and interests of all children. Materials that can be re-used and recycled like empty boxes, containers, cloth pieces, old newspapers etc. should also be included.

Safety:

Equipment should be appropriate and safe to use by children. They should not be too heavy and light with smooth edges/finishes. Finishes and dyes should be non-toxic.

Diversity and Flexibility:

It is important to ensure that the equipment in an ECCE centre reflects the community in which it is located. All materials and equipment should be selected with consideration to encourage acceptance of diversity such as race, culture etc. The materials must also be easily adaptable for facilitating learning in different developmental areas.

4.4.3 Maintenance and Utilization of Equipment and Learning Materials

It is essential to ensure that equipment are well maintained and in working order. The first step in this direction is regular inspection of the classroom, equipment and materials ensuring their long life. Teachers sometimes get discouraged about using materials that require intricate handling, assembling because of the time and energy involved in their maintenance. There are simple maintenance strategies which if used consistently make the job easier and also promote a sense of ownership and pride in the child. Some are discussed below:

- Dusting, cleaning and sterilising all equipment should be done regularly to avoid the spread of germs.
- Toys made of washable material should be washed and kept clean at all times to prevent spread of disease producing germs.
- Enough storage space is necessary to maintain cleanliness as well as for easy access of the materials at the time of use. Space to store children's personal belongings is also essential.
- All storage containers and shelves must be labelled with pictures or words. While the initial set up of a labelling system is time-consuming, once in place, it helps children and the staff to put back the materials in their designated places. It also encourages independence and ownership among children.
- Organise storage of small items like beads, crayons, picture cards etc in labelled tubs or baskets for easy clean-up.
- Try to place areas requiring clean up in close proximity to a water source with available cleaning materials.
- Materials that have not been used for a long time may be rotated frequently and new things added to sustain the interest of children.
- All electrical appliances and equipment should be out of the reach of children. They need to be checked regularly and repaired immediately to avoid any accident.

4.5 SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- What are the essential outdoor and indoor facilities needed for an ECCE Centre?
- Suggest some maintenance strategies of learning materials.

4.6 PRACTICAL WORK / PROJECT / ASSIGNMENT

- Visit an ECCE Centre and prepare a detailed note on outdoor and indoor facilities available at the centre.

4.7 FURTHER READING

- https://www.flexiprep.com/NIOS-Notes/Secondary/Early-Childhood-Care-and-Education/NIOS-Class-10-Unit-15-Profile-of-an-ECCE-Centre-Part-2.html
- https://digital.nios.ac.in/content/376en/15.pdf
- https://www.virtuallabschool.org/preschool/learning-environments/lesson-2

Unit 5: HUMAN RESOURCES

5.1 INTRODUCTION

The experiences which children go through the first six years of life last influence on their minds and lays the foundation for development of their personality. It therefore, becomes important for the adults to take proper care of the children during these normative years and create an environment best suited for their growth and development. A child at this stage needs an adult / teacher who has the necessary sensitivity, understanding and skills to handle young children. In an ECCE Centre, the personnel involved are the worker and helper. They both have an important role to play in influencing the child. It is necessary that the qualities, skills, roles and responsibilities of a good ECCE staff be understood so that one can appreciate their importance in the development of the child's personality. In this lesson, we have focussed on the staff in an ECCE centre.

5.2 HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Human Resource Management is the process of recruitment, selection of employee, providing proper orientation and introduction, providing proper training and the developing skills, assessment of employee (performance of appraisal), providing proper compensation and benefits, motivating, maintaining proper relations with labour and with trade unions, maintaining employee's safety, welfare and health by complying with labour laws of the state.

5.2.1 Importance of Human Resource Management

An organization cannot build a good team of working professionals without good Human Resources. A HR team should do an active role in any organisation such as

strategy management, benefits analysis, training and development and interactivity within employees, etc

The key functions of the Human Resources Management (HRM) team include recruiting people, training them, performance appraisals, motivating employees as well as workplace communication, workplace safety, and much more.

5.2.2 Recruitment and Selection

This is one of the major responsibilities of the human resource team. The HR managers come up with plans and strategies for hiring the right kind of people. For a preschool, the staff whether teaching or non-teaching, needs to be experienced, trained and genuinely interested in spending time with the kids. Disinterested individuals can create problems and negative impact on the tiny minds.

5.2.3 Performance Appraisals

HRM encourages the people working in an organization to work according to their potential and gives them suggestions that can help them to bring about improvement in it. The team communicates with the staff individually from time to time and provides all the necessary information regarding their performances and also defines their respective roles. This is beneficial as it enables them to form an outline of their anticipated goals in much clearer terms and thereby, helps them execute the goals with best possible efforts. Performance appraisals, when taken on a regular basis, motivate the employees.

5.2.4 Maintaining good Work Atmosphere

This is a vital aspect of HRM because the performance of an individual in an organization is largely driven by the work atmosphere or work culture that prevails at the workplace. A good working condition is one of the benefits that the employees can expect from an efficient human resource team. A safe, clean atmosphere gives the staff members job satisfaction as well.

5.2.5 Managing Disputes

In an organization, there are several issues on which disputes may arise between the employees and the employers. You can say conflicts are almost inevitable. It is the responsibility of the HRM team which acts as a consultant and mediator to sort out those issues in an effective manner. They first hear the grievances of the employees. Then they come up with suitable solutions to sort them out. In other words, they take timely action and prevent things from going out of hands.

5.2.6 Developing Public Relations

The responsibility of establishing good public relations lies with the HRM to a great extent. They organize business meetings, seminars and various official gatherings on behalf of the company in order to build up relationships with other business sectors. Sometimes, the HR department plays an active role in preparing the business and marketing plans for the organization too.

Any organization, without a proper setup for HRM is bound to suffer from serious problems while managing its regular activities. For this reason, today companies must put a lot of effort and energy into setting up a strong and effective HRM.

5.3 SELECTION OF ECCE STAFF

For the efficient running of an ECCE centre it is essential that the staff should be selected keeping in mind the needs of the children who would be attending the centre. The staff involved in the ECCE centre includes the worker and helper.

5.3.1 ECCE Worker

The ECCE worker is a key person who can influence the quality of service provided at the centre. She is the person responsible for the activities and programmes conducted in the ECCE centre. To achieve the established goals and objectives, we must select a person who can function as a worker for an ECCE Centre with the right kind of educational qualifications and professional training. It is desirable that the worker in the centre should have:

- Passed Class X with two years training in Early Childhood Care and Education
- Passed Class XII with one year training in Early Childhood Care and Education

Vocational courses such as Nursery Teacher's Training (NTT) are good options for someone who is interested in working with pre-schoolers. These courses give theoretical as well as practical knowledge that would make a person better prepared for her job as an ECCE worker.

In case of non-availability of qualified persons, the minimum qualification can be reduced to Class VIII with short-term training supplemented with frequent refresher and on-the-job training. Members of the community can also be selected for working in the centre. They can be provided with the necessary orientation in the initial stages and frequent refresher courses can also be organised for them.

There are some other qualities which can determine the selection of the worker. Prior experience of working with young children would prepare the individual for a variety of situations that may arise while dealing with young children. As the person would

have worked with a number of children, she would be better able to appreciate that each child has her own individuality and can accept them as they are.

Each community has its own unique features in terms of its social customs, beliefs, and practices. The members of that community would obviously want their younger generation to acquire their social values. Part of this is accomplished through the parents and other adult members of the society. Education also plays an important role in this process.

Education during the first few years of a child would definitely influence the overall personality of the child. Thus, it is desirable that an ECCE worker is someone from the local community so that she is aware of the social values and customs of the children and would be able to deal better with the typical characteristics of the children, parents and the community at large.

An ECCE worker has to be always alert and quick to respond. This quality of alertness would be beneficial for a candidate's selection as an ECCE worker. Creativity and the ability to innovate and improvise are some of the other factors which can be a hint for selectors while choosing a worker for an ECCE centre.

5.3.2 ECCE Helper

The ECCE worker also needs a helper who would be responsible for the maintenance of the ECCE centre. It is important that the helper is a person who is ready to care for the children at all times. She should be a lover of nature. The helper should have some knowledge about children and should be able to handle situations in case the ECCE worker is not around. A person having completed her eighth standard would be suited for the job of a helper.

5.4 SKILLS OF A GOOD ECCE WORKER

What the child gains during these years largely determine what kind of person the child will become as an adult. Therefore, the first major skill that a good ECCE worker should have is a thorough understanding of the importance of the ECCE experience on the growth of the child.

The skills that would be beneficial for the ECCE worker are presented in the following:

- Aware of the needs of children
- Knowledge of teaching methods
- Use of locally available material
- Innovation
- Creativity
- Flexibility

5.5 PERSONAL QUALITIES OF ECCE STAFF

Children need love and affection from their caregivers. A warm, loving and secure atmosphere fosters the overall development of the child. The ECCE staff has to understand the child's view and be sensitive towards its needs.

In order that a worker is successful in providing guidance to children, she must possess certain qualities:

- She must remain emotionally mature and stable. She should take care to ensure that her personal problems do not have an adverse effect on the children or the activities.
- She should be calm and patient.
- She should be consistent in her behaviour. If certain rules are laid down, she should abide by them.
- She should be enthusiastic about working with children.

- A relaxed and smiling worker with soft, pleasant voice will receive better response from the children.
- She should be a good listener.
- She has to be patient. She should allow time for children to help themselves.
- She should have the ability to build good relationships with the children, other members of the ECCE centre, parents of the children attending the centre and other community members.
- The ECCE worker should look and feel comfortable while working with the children.
- She should be interested in keeping herself abreast with the latest information on child development and effective teaching methodology.
- She should be able to motivate and support other staff members and involve them in successful running of the centre.

5.6 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF ECCE STAFF

For the smooth functioning of an ECCE centre, it is important that the roles and responsibilities of each member of the staff are clearly specified. There should be minimum of overlap so that there is no confusion

5.6.1 ECCE worker

- The planning of activities to be conducted at the centre has to be done by the ECCE worker. Her knowledge about children would be useful in this process.
- The worker is responsible for planning both short-term and long-term goals. Short-term goals include the daily weekly plans of programmes and activities to be conducted at the centre. Long-term goals are the overall objectives of running the centre. This long-term worker has to specify what she hopes to achieve at the end of one year through the programme.
- The planning of programmes is done in detail in the last lesson.

- The overall responsibility of satisfying the various needs of children are applied on the worker. She has to make sure that each child feels comfortable at the centre and participates freely in all the activities.
- The ECCE worker also plays the role of the manager of the centre. As already discussed, a good ECCE worker is responsible for the success of the centre. She has to handle not only the children but also other members of the centre, organise various programmes, coordinate with other institutions (such as funding agencies etc.), mobilise community support, involve parents in the centre and also evaluate the effectiveness of the ECCE centre.
- The records and registers are to be maintained by the worker.
- If the centre provides mid-day meals, the worker has the responsibility of planning the meals, supervising its preparation and distribution.
- The worker is also responsible for the health of the child. She has to arrange regular health check-ups by coordinating with a doctor. She should have basic knowledge about first aid and be able to handle emergencies. She should also be aware about immunization/vaccination and arrange for them as per the needs.
- The worker should be aware of the norms for development and should be able to identify any delay in development of children.

5.6.2 Helper

The helper in the ECCE centre acts as an assistant to the worker. The house keeping services needed in the centre like cleaning, washing the utensil, care of playground, maintenance of equipment and other items in the centre require a helper. The helper has to be with the children when they go to the toilets or playground. The helper is responsible for the proper cleanliness of the ECCE centre. If food is served, the helper can cook the meal and assist in its distribution among children.

In case the worker is busy or unable to come to the centre some day, the helper should be able to handle the children in a manner that the daily routine is not disturbed. The helper should also maintain a link with the children's parents.

Throughout this lesson, we have discussed the ECCE worker in the female gender. This is so because during these early years children move out of their home for the first time and would look for a mother figure in the ECCE worker. A female worker would be more able to fulfil this need in the ECCE worker. A female worker would be more sensitive, caring and loving, just as a mother. However, if the selectors find a man who has these qualities and who seems to enjoy working with children, such a worker should be selected as gender does not play a significant role in the efficiency of a good ECCE worker.

5.7 SKILL DEVELOPMENT OF ECCE STAFF

In order to maintain the efficiency of the staff, it is important that regular training programmes are organised. Such activities would improve the worker's awareness about the latest information on child development and new teaching methods and enhance their working capabilities. Any person who is interested in working with children but who does not have the required educational or professional qualification can also be trained.

5.7.1 Areas for skill development

It is desirable that a worker:

- knows the various principles of growth and development and how they are applied
- planning activities in an ECCE centre

- is aware about the various needs of the child-physical, social, emotional and intellectual
- is clear about the objectives of Early Childhood Care and Education
- is able to plan programmes and activities for an ECCE centre
- can utilize resources which are readily available in the most efficient way
- knows the different teaching methods which are effective while working with young children
- is able to involve the parents and other community members in the functioning of the ECCE centre
- can manage the entire ECCE centre activities, equipment, finance, and mobilize community support and supervision

5.7.2 Process of skill development

The best method for improving a worker's skills of working with children is to provide her with lots of first hand experience. This can be done by providing placements in various ECCE centres and letting the trainees experience for themselves how to work with children.

Activities to enhance creativity such as toy making, painting, storytelling, music and movement can be given to the trainees. All efforts by the trainees should be appreciated and they should be encouraged to improve.

The worker in an ECCE centre should always remember that she has an important role in shaping the personality of the children who attend the centre. She should constantly try to improve her performance so that children have the maximum benefits.

5.8 METHOD OF RESOLVING CONFLICTS

Conflict or more specifically interpersonal conflict is a fact of life and particularly of organizational life. It often emerges more when people are stressed, for example, when there are changes on the horizon, or when everyone is under pressure because of a looming deadline. However, conflict can also arise in relationships and situations outside work.

5.8.1 Mediation

Sometimes, two individuals in a conflict simply can't work it out together without the aid of a third party. If your workers conflict has escalated to the point where outside intervention is necessary, set up a mediation session. Train a staff member in the art of mediation. Allow this staff to sit down with the disputing individuals and assist them in working through their problems in a productive manner.

5.8.2 Compromise

Ask each person to give a little and take a little by arranging a compromise between the two. Ask both the members to come to your office and talk the problem with them, presenting potential compromises and allowing them to mull these options over. By arranging a compromise instead of just selecting one member's interests over the other, you can reduce the likelihood that one staff member feeling slighted when the conflict was resolved.

5.9 SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- State the personal qualities of a good ECCE worker and helper.
- What are the criteria to be kept in mind while selecting the staff at ECCE Centre?

- How to resolve conflicts among staff?
- Brief the importance of HRM in an ECCE Centre.

5.10 PRACTICAL WORK / PROJECT / ASSIGNMENT

- Conduct a mock session on selection procedure of staff for an ECCE Centre

5.11 FURTHER READING

- https://digital.nios.ac.in/content/376en/15.pdf
- https://www.unesco.org/en/education/early-childhood
- https://wcd.nic.in/sites/default/files/national_ecce_curr_framework_final_03022014%20%282%29.pdf
- Gupta, S. (2009). *Early Childhood Care and Education*. New Delhi: PHI Learning Pvt. Ltd.

Unit 6: COMMUNITY RESOURCES

6.1 INTRODUCTION

Just having a good centre with proper facilities and able staff is not enough. It is also important that you make the community around the ECCE centre aware and mobilise its full support. A community is made up of all the members of families near the centre, as well as the local community workers and people working in the various local institutes. For an ECCE centre to develop successfully, the support of your community is very essential. In this lesson you are going to learn how to make a community aware about ECCE and how to mobilise or get its support.

6.2 ROLE OF COMMUNITY

Community is defined as "a feeling of fellowship with others, as a result of sharing common attitudes, interests, and goals." For children, a sense of community brings connection both to their surroundings and the individuals in those surroundings — further connecting them to their own unique place in the world.

The community is an important stakeholder in the preschool education programme. Involvement and participation of the community members would help in understanding children and their family better. Only if the community is aware, the needs of children can be fulfilled. Community awareness could be achieved through the following:

• Awareness generation programmes including disability-related myths regarding young children, through folk songs, street plays, puppet shows, *jathas*, etc.

6.3 NEED FOR COMMUNITY AWARENESS

To a large extent, our communities today are unaware about early childhood care and education and cannot understand why a child, who is not yet four years old, has to go to a play centre to learn. According to most people, the mother is the best teacher till four years of age. Some others may feel that the play centre might teach some value to the child that will be contrary to what they want to offer to their child. Still others will feel that taking a child to a play centre is too much of a burden on her to learn.

In other cases, people feel that by taking a child to a play centre, the mother has to spend time bringing the child back home in the afternoon. Such a bother that it is better not to send the child at all.

To set aside all these fears, you, as an ECCE worker need to orient the community. In other words, you need to make the community aware of early childhood education and help them realise its importance. Knowing about early childhood care and education will also help the community in various other ways. These are as follows:

- It will help to remove gender discrimination and community that is aware about ECCE will be more willing to send girls to ECCE centre.
- Community that is aware about ECCE will also be more conscious about vaccinations, immunization of children, and will take more care about sanitation and hygiene.
- A community which is aware about ECCE will also realize that it has to play a great role in the child's life and will try to be a better role model.

6.4 METHODS OF MOBILISING COMMUNITY SUPPORT

Various methods to mobilise community support are given below.

6.4.1 Community Meetings

Community meetings are an important event in the initial period of the play centre. Adequate care to follow certain guidelines, the meetings called by you should be attended in large numbers.

To organize a community meeting, the first thing you can do is to approach a senior person of the community who is well respected. We can call him/her the 'nodal' person. After explaining to him/her about the importance and necessity of an ECCE play centre in that locality, motivate the person to invite other people of the neighborhood.

All required demonstration etc. should be arranged beforehand. Posters, blackboard, toys for presentation should always be in the ECCE centre preferably.

On the day of the meeting, be present before anyone else comes. When everyone has arrived, introduce yourself and thank them for being there. In a very simple language explain to them the ECCE methods.

6.4.2 Setting up a Community Education Committee

To ensure that the community always gives its support, a community education committee may be set up. Besides support, the committee can provide a lot of help to the centre in the form of advice. Being a member of committee will motivate the people to help the centre in a better way and to motivate other people in turn.

6.4.3 Organizing Orientation Programmes

After the community knows about ECCE through the community meetings, it is necessary to conduct orientation programmes. The orientation programmes are necessary to educate the community about ECCE methods and to help the community appreciate these methods.

In initial orientation programmes the people can be shown how an ECCE centre functions. They can be asked to act as children for a day and you can be the teacher. This method will give them a first hand experience and will help them a lot in appreciating the ECCE methods in the centre. Let them ask any question.

If you do not have an answer to something, do not evade the question. Tell the truth that you don't have the answer at the moment but you will find it out and let them know at the earliest.

Secondly, people of the community can be called in to assist in the actual class. This will give them a sense of belongingness and also motivate them to learn more about ECCE.

Finally, a camp can be held in the ECCE centre where community members are the participants. Camps can be either residential (overnight) or non-residential. People with daily wages will not be willing to attend these camps.

Additionally, some people will think that the camp will be too uninteresting. Here, you will again need the help of the nodal person.

6.4.4 Street Dramas and Rallies

Puppet shows, lively dramas and skits using the local language can be enacted in the streets to create an interest in people. Rallies also help a lot. These will motivate people to visit the ECCE centre.

6.4.5 Inviting People to Participate as Substitute Teachers

Besides orienting the people, being a substitute teacher will help a lot in motivating the community members.

6.4.6 Inviting People with Specific Skill for Demonstration

This will also help in mobilising community support. Specific skills, as helping children develop painting, sewing, singing and so on. Besides, this will also develop a sense of belongingness with the ECCE centre.

6.4.7 Home Visits

Home visits are important as they are more direct and face-to-face. Specific questions asked by people can be answered more easily. The family background, beliefs and way of life of the child should be kept in mind when dealing with questions. Keep the visit informal and make ECCE very interesting and non-threatening to their environment.

6.5 AREAS OF COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION

Members of the community can be involved in almost all activities of the ECCE centres. The community comprises mothers, fathers, skilled and unskilled, professional and non-professional persons, each of whom can contribute towards the healthy development of the centre.

Community participation can be in the areas shown in the following:

- Pre set-up
- During set-up
- Post set-up

6.5.1 PRE SET-UP

Before a centre is set up, you need to do some survey to find out:

- Occupation of the families
- Problems faced by the children
- Food habits
- Play facilities available to the children
- Whether the community is aware of ECCE
- Social taboos, if any
- Availability of safe drinking water
- Whether children are permitted to play
- Whether children are immunized
- Common diseases of the area
- Whether community is aware of sanitation, nutrition and environment
- Whether any NGOs or women groups are working in the area
- Situation of the girl-child
- Presence of a community leader, if any
- Most respected person in the community

6.5.2 DURING SET-UP

1. Fencing and outdoor play equipment

While construction of the building is going on, other members of the community can be motivated to help in making fences and also building outdoor play equipment like seesaws, sand-pits, swings, etc.

2. Toilet and Safe Drinking Water

If no toilet is available, the community members can help to construct a covered toilet. Explain the importance of sanitation and hygiene and stress the importance of a toilet.

Safe drinking water is very essential for an ECCE centre. Community members can help in the construction of a tube well or well, if no facility is available. Here also, stress the importance of safe water and show them how to keep water clean and safe.

3. Preparation of teaching/learning material

Organise a workshop where you can explain the kinds of teaching/learning material an ECCE centre requires. Ask community members to bring locally available material and prepare toys, teaching aids in the local fashion. The workshop should be made enjoyable and everyone should be encouraged to join.

6.5.3 POST SET-UP

1. Sending children to the centre

This is the most important contribution of the community. It depends on how far or how well you motivated the community through the nodal group.

2. Maintenance of Building

After the building is built, the surroundings as well as the centre will still need maintenance regularly. The duty of maintaining the centre can be allotted to various members of the community and can be done by turns. Every Sunday, a group of community members may come and repair things, clean the garden, mend fences, etc. Thus, every person can take a turn in doing something for the society.

3. Monitoring of Day-to-Day activities

The administrator of the centre can seek the help of the community members to assist you in day-to-day activities like accounts, administration and teaching.

4. Cooking

Even if your centre does not have any facility for providing afternoon meals, you may encourage the community members to provide meals for the children. This can either be done by a group of two persons may be fixed for this. The centre can pay a very low amount of money for the food at no loss/no profit basis. Also the centre may provide the raw materials for the food which the community members may prepare and give back to the centre.

6.6 SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- Describe the importance of community support in ECCE.
- Discuss the methods of eliciting community support in establishment and development of an ECCE centre.
- What are the areas in which community can participate in development of an ECCE centre?

6.7 PRACTICAL WORK/ PROJECT / ASSIGNMENT

- Conduct a seminar on "Establishing the link between Community and ECCE Centre".

6.8 FURTHER READING

- https://digital.nios.ac.in/content/376/en/15.pdf
- https://www.unesco.org/en/education/early-childhood
- Gupta, S. (2009). *Early Childhood Care and Education*. New Delhi: PHI Learning Pvt. Ltd.
- https://www.all4kids.org/news/blog/benefits-of-community-involvement-in-early-childhood/

- https://www.flexiprep.com/NIOS-Notes/Secondary/Early-Childhood-Care-and-Education/NIOS-Class-10-Unit-18-Involvement-of-Parents-and-Community-Part-2.html

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Ansha Montessori Teacher Training Institute (AMTTI)

Chennai, Tamil Nadu

Academic Note

Learners are encouraged to supplement this material with practical observations, classroom activities, and reference resources to enhance their understanding of early childhood care and education.